

Specialists and Mercenaries

During the game, characters may need to hire NPCs with training or special skills in a certain area. These people are known as *specialists*. Specialists are not retainers and they will not go on adventures. However, a character may hire as many specialists as can be afforded. Specialists are located by posting notices (the DM should decide the cost for posting the notices). The ads may be answered by none, one, or many persons depending on the DM's decision. This may be influenced by the type of specialist wanted, the size of the local population, the reputation of the employer, and the amount of money or bonus offered. The player must then select who to hire from the applicants and work out the details of salary with each, the DM taking the role of the NPCs in these sessions. The DM may wish to establish guilds for various professions where certain types of specialists are commonly found.

Mercenaries are hired soldiers who will do typical army work. Like specialists they will usually not go on dungeon adventures and will only participate in wilderness adventures such as fighting other armies, clearing land of monsters around the castle, and defending the castle. Players should be aware of the morale of their mercenaries because high death rates, low pay, and other unappealing treatment will cause them to revolt or desert their lord. Good treatment and safe, but exciting service will lead to greater loyalty, as will success on the battlefield.

Some descriptions and costs of typical specialists and mercenaries are given below. Other specialists may be created as the DM wishes.

Alchemist (1000 gp/month). If given the formula or a sample, an alchemist may make a potion at half the normal time and cost. They may also conduct research into different types of potions at twice the cost and time required for a magic-user.

Armorer (100 gp/month). For every 50 fighters hired by a character, 1 armorer will be necessary to maintain their weapons and equipment. Any armorer not so employed may make non-magical armor and weapons at the rate of 1 suit of armor, 3 shields, or 5 weapons per month. For every 3 assistants (one of which must be a smith) the output may be doubled. One armorer may manage 6 assistants.

Animal Trainer (500 gp/month). An animal trainer is needed to train and control any type of creature other than a horse, mule, or dog, although trainers may be necessary if many horses, mules or dogs are kept. Each trainer is skilled with only one type of creature. If a character wished to train a hippogriff, a hippogriff trainer would be required. Each trainer may handle up to 6 animals.

The time needed to train animals is decided by the DM, but the following guideline may be used: the first "trick" or maneuver taught will require at least a month, and each additional trick or skill will take at least another 2 weeks. The lengths of time involved will vary with the intelligence of the animal, the complexity of the trick or maneuver, etc. Training must be continuous, or the animal becomes "untrainable".

Engineer (750 gp/month). An engineer is needed for the construction of castles and large structures. Dwarven engineers usually specialize in tunnelling. One engineer must be hired for every 100,000 gp that a construction costs.

Sage (2000 gp/month). A sage is an advisor, capable of answering questions involving great knowledge. For each uncommon question they attempt to answer there will always be a chance of failure. The DM will have to decide on the amount of time it takes and the cost of the research for each question. They are extremely rare and the DM may want to limit the number in a campaign.

